

Getting Ready for Your Second Guided AI Session

A short guide to read before you begin

This guide explains what will happen in your second session with the AI assistant. Reading it first means you'll know what to expect, why the session is shaped the way it is, and how to get the most out of it. It takes just a few minutes to read.

Welcome back — from your first session to this one

In your first session, you looked closely at a single moment — how one situation can spark an automatic thought, which stirs an emotion, which shapes how you act and how your body responds, all looping back on itself. You also met the cognitive distortions, and began noticing the little tricks the mind can play.

This session zooms out. Instead of one moment, you'll sketch the bigger map of your life right now: the handful of problems you'd most like to be free from, and the goals and dreams you'd like to move toward. It's a gentle, bird's-eye view — and it gives you and your therapist a shared picture to steer by in the months ahead.

Good to know: There are no right or wrong answers, and nothing here is a test. This is your own honest snapshot of where things stand today — nothing more. The scores you'll give are simply a way to make your progress visible over time.

What this session is

You'll work through two simple tools with the AI guide:

- the **Color-Coded Problem Hierarchy (CCPH)** — the main problems you'd like to work on, and
- the **Color-Coded Goals/Aspirations Hierarchy (CCGH)** — the goals and aspirations you'd like to move toward.

Both use the same friendly 0-to-5 scale, where every number also has a color. You'll give each problem and each goal a score, and those colors let you — and your therapist — see at a glance where things feel heaviest, and watch them change as you go.

Who you'll be talking to

As before, you'll be chatting with an AI assistant set up to guide this one exercise — a friendly companion for this particular step. A few things to keep in mind:

- It is not a replacement for your therapist or doctor. It's guiding one exercise, not managing your overall care.
- It won't diagnose you, judge you, or tell you what your scores “should” be. The scores are always yours.
- It stays gently focused on this exercise. If you raise something else, it will kindly keep to the task and suggest saving that for your therapist.

How the session will flow

The session moves through a clear, unhurried sequence. You don't need to memorise it — the AI leads the way — but here's the shape so nothing feels out of the blue.

Part 1 — Mapping your problems (the CCPH)

First, the guide will invite you to name the most important problems you'd like to work on — up to five, though fewer is completely fine. The framing is hopeful and forward-looking: over the next few months of therapy, what would you most like to be free from — to be able to “breathe” from?

Then you'll rate each problem from 0 to 5 using the color-coded scale below.

The Color-Coded Problem Scale (CCPH)

0	LIGHT BLUE Problem is small and its solution is easy (or it is not a problem anymore)	DISCOMFORT Bothers you, but you can still manage it
1	DARK BLUE Problem elicits discomfort, but its solution is relatively easy	
2	LIGHT GREEN Problem elicits clear discomfort, and/or its solution is difficult	
3	DARK GREEN Problem elicits much discomfort, and/or its solution is very difficult	
4	YELLOW Problem elicits distress, and its solution is very difficult	DISTRESS Feels overwhelming — where therapy focuses most
5	RED Problem elicits so much distress that I can't see a solution	

The Color-Coded Problem Scale (CCPH). Copyright: Irismar Reis de Oliveira; trial-basedcognitivetherapy.com.

About those colors: Scores 0 to 3 (the blues and greens) mark **discomfort** — things that bother you but that you can still manage. Scores 4 (yellow) and 5 (red) mark **distress** — where things feel overwhelming. And here's something worth knowing: the yellow and red items aren't the ones to avoid. They're usually exactly where therapy does its most valuable work.

A small but important tip: Where you can, it helps to name a problem in terms of something **you can influence**. For example, rather than “my mother is ill” — which is outside your control — something like “how I'm coping with my mother's illness.” That way your score can actually move

as you grow, even when the situation itself doesn't change. The guide may gently suggest this; you're always free to keep your own wording.

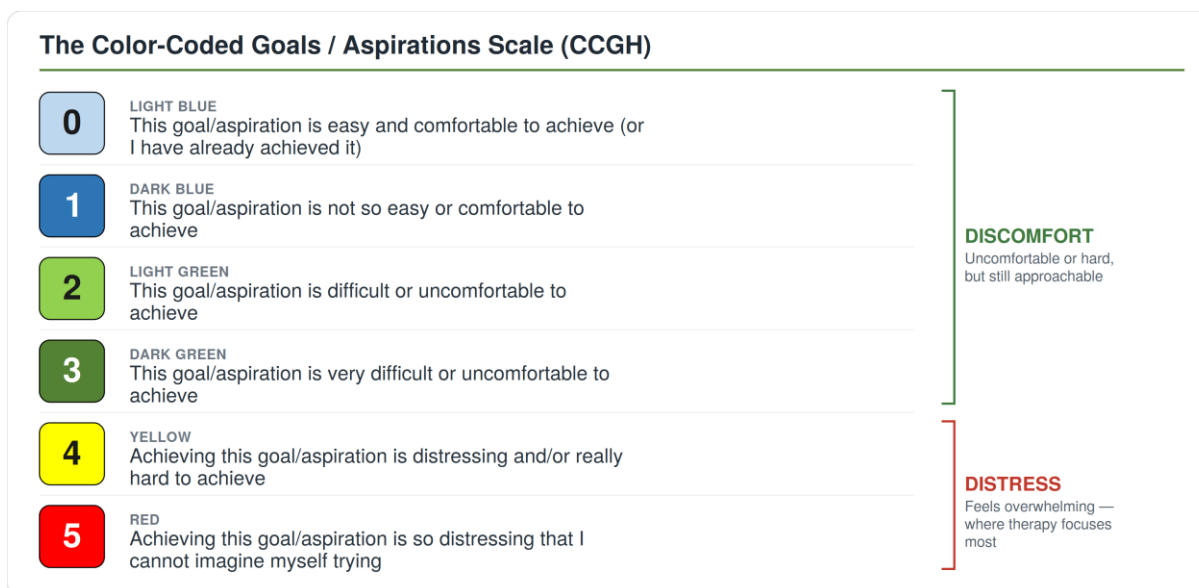
Something private? That's okay too: Everyone has things they'd rather not put into words — that's completely normal. If something is weighing on you but you'd prefer to keep it private for now, you can still give it a place on your list, simply called **X, Y, or Z**. You never have to explain what it is, and the guide will never ask. Just knowing it's there, and tracking how it feels over time, can still be part of your progress.

Part 2 — Mapping your goals & aspirations (the CCGH)

Next, the guide turns to the brighter side: the goals and aspirations you'd like to move toward. Again, up to five, and fewer is fine.

Some goals will be the flip side of a problem — overcoming a fear, easing a strain. But others can stand entirely on their own: things you'd love to do, experience, build, or become, even long-held dreams that feel far off. Those belong here too. For a distant dream, the question simply becomes: what's one small thing you could do now to start moving toward it?

You'll rate each goal for how hard or distressing it feels to pursue right now, using the same 0-to-5 scale.



The Color-Coded Goals/Aspirations Scale (CCGH). Copyright: Irismar Reis de Oliveira; trial-basedcognitivetherapy.com.

Seeing your progress over time

These lists aren't one-and-done. Every so often you'll re-rate the same items, and the scores — and their colors — will shift. That's the whole point: to make your progress visible, even when it happens slowly.

Watching your colors shift over time



The same items, re-rated over time.

Each month you rate your problems and goals again. The numbers — and their colours — change as you make progress.

The aim: reds and yellows gradually shifting toward greens and blues.

You won't see your earlier scores while you re-rate, so each rating is fresh and honest. Once you're done, your guide reveals the whole journey side by side.

Over time, the aim is to watch reds and yellows shift toward greens and blues.

Why you won't see your old scores: When you re-rate, the guide keeps your earlier numbers hidden so today's rating stays fresh and honest — old scores can quietly pull new ones toward them. Once you've finished, the full journey is revealed, so you can see just how far you've come.

What the conversation will feel like

- **Lots of gentle questions.** The guide leads mostly by asking, not lecturing. Take your time answering.
- **One thing at a time.** It asks about one problem or goal before moving to the next, so nothing piles up.
- **Unhurried.** There's no clock, and no need to have polished answers ready.
- **Okay to be unsure.** If a score feels like it's between two numbers, just say so — the guide will help you weigh them.
- **Conversational.** It's meant to feel like talking with a knowledgeable friend, not filling in a form.

What to have ready before you start

1. **The two rating cards.** You'll use them to choose your scores. Both are printed in the Annex at the end of this guide — have them open or printed nearby. The guide will check you have them before each part begins.
2. **A sense of what's weighing on you — and what you're hoping for.** You don't need a finished list; it's perfectly normal for problems and goals to surface as you talk.
3. **A quiet moment.** Set aside a stretch of uninterrupted time where you can focus and reply thoughtfully.
4. **Optional — your color-coded chart.** If your therapist has shared your spreadsheet or graph, having it on screen lets you watch the colors as you go. It's helpful, but not required.

A few tips to get the most from it

- Answer honestly — the scores only reflect what you put into them, and they're for you, not for anyone to judge.
- There's no “good” or “bad” total. A high score isn't a failure; it's simply the starting point you'll measure your progress from.
- If the guide keeps to the exercise when you raise something else, that's by design — save other topics for your therapist.
- Afterwards, keep the rating cards handy. Noticing where your problems and goals sit between sessions is part of the work.

What this session is not

So there are no surprises, here's what the AI won't do:

- It won't diagnose you or manage your treatment.
- It won't provide crisis support or emergency care.
- It won't carry out deeper TBCT techniques — those are introduced later, by your therapist.
- It won't push you to share anything you'd rather keep private, and it will never ask what your X, Y, or Z stands for.

If you're in distress This session is a learning and planning exercise, not an emergency service. If at any point you feel overwhelmed, or you have thoughts of harming yourself, please pause and reach out to your study clinician or your local emergency services right away. Your safety matters more than finishing the exercise.

You don't need to prepare anything else — the AI will guide you step by step. When you're ready, begin whenever you like.

Your Two Rating Cards

Keep these nearby during your session. You'll use them to choose a score from 0 to 5 for each problem and each goal. This is exactly the wording your guide will use — read it over beforehand so the numbers feel familiar.

Color-Coded Problem Hierarchy (CCPH)

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS
0 Light blue	Problem is small and its solution is easy (or it is not a problem anymore)
1 Dark blue	Problem elicits discomfort, but its solution is relatively easy
2 Light green	Problem elicits clear discomfort, and/or its solution is difficult
3 Dark green	Problem elicits much discomfort, and/or its solution is very difficult
4 Yellow	Problem elicits distress, and its solution is very difficult
5 Red	Problem elicits so much distress that I can't see a solution

Color-Coded Goals / Aspirations Hierarchy (CCGH)

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS
0 Light blue	This goal/aspiration is easy and comfortable to achieve (or I have already achieved it)
1 Dark blue	This goal/aspiration is not so easy or comfortable to achieve
2 Light green	This goal/aspiration is difficult or uncomfortable to achieve
3 Dark green	This goal/aspiration is very difficult or uncomfortable to achieve

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS
4 Yellow	Achieving this goal/aspiration is distressing and/or really hard to achieve
5 Red	Achieving this goal/aspiration is so distressing that I cannot imagine myself trying

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